The October Revolution

Also known as the Bolshevik Revolution, the October Revolution toppled the new provisional regime and founded the Soviet Union. This time, the rebels were far more organized than before because they were arranged into smaller groups. Bolsheviks led the revolution after planning extensively for 6 months. When the Bolsheviks first introduced themselves in 1917, they were not very popular with the Russian population. However by the end of the year, they had gained considerable support from the people because of their promises. Most of their supporters were located within Petrograd and other large cities.

By the end of 1917, the Bolsheviks finally came to realize that they simply could not hold onto power within an election-type government if they refused to share their power. In January of 1918, they abandoned democracy and declared themselves to be the leaders of a proletariat dictatorship. Many of the people had revolted earlier because they did not want a dictatorship. As a result, the country was plunged into the Russian Civil War that lasted until 1920.